

Cheat Codes For PRELIMS (Version 2.0)

(By IAS PCS Pathshala)

Read this Before Using this Document

Before anything, it is important to remember that **nothing can replace the knowledge you accumulate through studying standard books, test series, and PYQ analysis**. These intelligent elimination techniques may look promising because they provide a necessary support system in the exam, but **without studying basic resources, these techniques might prove to be fatal rather than fruitful**.

However, these techniques have consistently helped many aspirants to tackle random/unknown questions in the exam better and score better over the years. Therefore, I am sharing this document with you all.

I completely agree that UPSC Prelims can be cleared based on knowledge, but the fact is that our knowledge is limited to a point. A well-read aspirant may be able to attempt a maximum of 35-40 questions, but this is not sufficient to clear the cutoff. We have to push our boundaries, but not by choosing the option in some haphazard manner. This is where these techniques will come into play. If you are scoring below 50-60, then you have to increase your knowledge base by reading basic books, resources, and PYQs. In case you are hovering around 70-80, then these techniques will definitely help you to fetch that extra mark required to clear the cutoff.

Most objective type tests can be hacked if you observe the examiner carefully and outsmart their way of thinking. Those who attempt more and more UPSC papers somehow start noticing these hacks and tend to score a little better than others with that much-needed difference in the final exam.

Examiners at UPSC are, arguably, generalists rather than specialists or experts. When this is the case, framing a question becomes tricky because statements can be devised only based on the available information in the sources

rather than the complete subject knowledge of the examiner. ***The major difficulty experienced by an examiner is, therefore, in devising wrong statements that somehow appear deceptively correct.***

This makes their questions vulnerable to intelligent guessing and leads us to the key principle of our intelligent guess – "it is difficult to devise wrong statements."

That being said, there is absolutely no guarantee that these techniques will work this year too, but if you see, in UPSC, there is no guarantee for anything. There is no guarantee that Modern History will be asked from Spectrum. No guarantee that the Polity Question could be solved by reading Laxmikant. Maybe not a single question will come from PT 365.

Happy Studying :)

Monday	1	8	15	22	29
Tuesday	2	9	16	23	30
Wednesday	3	10	17	24	-
Thursday	4	11	18	25	-
Friday	5	12	19	26	-
Saturday	6	13	20	27	-
Sunday	7	14	21	28	-

Cheat Codes for Prelims 2.0

① Think as examiner. "Hard to verify facts"
[more clearly in History / SAT]

② Common Sense is ~~not so~~ 'common'
'Over Analysis leads to Paralysis'

③ Extreme statements → Beware.

Ex All, None, Only, Always, Never, Drastically,
Entirely, Enormously, completely, Mandatory,
Continuously. [Be careful with Polity &c]
+ More than one statement]

④ Probable Statement / Moderate Statement generally correct.

Ex: Can Be, May Be, Seems to be, likely to be,
may lead to, might be, expected to improve/
decline.

⑤ Numbers / Data can mislead / misleading.

[3 statement → 2 Data then ① correct]

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⑥ Steadily / consistently increasing / decreasing will be wrong.

⑦ Opposite Answers / Similar Looking Statements. One of them would be right.

⑧ for this and 'NOT' for this.

⑨ Ministry / Organisation / Parent Body → generally wrong but objective correct.

⑩ Bonus Tips

a) Trust Probability Science.

[2 Options Eliminated → Must Attempt.]

$$\left[\begin{array}{l} 10Q - R \\ 10Q - W \end{array} \right\} \rightarrow 13.4 \text{ (tre)}]$$

notes

Phone

email

website

b) Instead of Reading All Organisation and Reports → Read only Imp.

MAY '20

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Day 144-222 Wk-21
SATURDAY

Monday	4	11	18	25
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Imp. one → WB, IMF, WEF, UN Organisation Report.

c) If in option → Buddhism & Jainism is give. one will be correct.

d) Pds are Repeated.

① Progressive Step of Gort will be correct.

UPSC will never goes against 'Our Beloved PM'

Focus on the connotation → Decentralisation, 

People centric Approach, Positive step, Public Participation

Poverty Alleviation, Equality, Sustainability etc.

notes

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